Brando Miranda

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Google Scholar; Website; Stanford Profile; MIT Website

Research Interests

AI for formal mathematics — Lean 4 theorem proving, autoformalization, and end-to-end formal verification of software and mathematics; contamination-resistant evaluation of LLM mathematical reasoning; data-centric machine learning for foundation and frontier models; alternative architectures (e.g. energy-based models) toward Artificial General Intelligence (AGI).

Education

Ph.D. in Computer Science *2022-2026 (expected)*
Stanford University GPA: 4.045/4.0
Advisor: Prof. Sanmi Koyejo, Stanford Trustworthy AI Research Group (STAIR).

Master of Engineering in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science *2014-2016*
Massachusetts Institute of Technology GPA: 4.8/5.0
Advisor: Prof. Tomaso Poggio, Center for Brains, Minds and Machines.
Thesis Title: *Function Approximation with Deep Neural and Gaussian Networks.*

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science and Engineering *2010-2014*
Massachusetts Institute of Technology Minors: Mathematics, Music

Awards & Honors

- **ICML 2026 Silver Reviewer** (May 2026) — top reviewer recognition, signed by the ICML 2026 Program Chairs.
- **Oral Recommendation (Top 1)**, 2nd AI for Math Workshop @ ICML 2025 — for *VeriBench: End-to-End Formal Verification Benchmark for AI Code Generation in Lean 4* (Miranda et al.); reviewer recommendation "Accept (Oral, Top 1)".
- **Pear AI Researchers Circle** (July 2025) — selective AI-researcher network convened by Pear VC; invited following the final round (R3) of the Pear AI Researcher Grant program.
- **ICML Workshop on Trustworthy Multi-modal Foundation Models and AI Agents (TiFA) — Outstanding Paper Award** (July 2024) — for "Why Has Predicting Downstream Capabilities of Frontier AI Models with Scale Remained Elusive?"
- **NeurIPS Outstanding Main Track Paper Award** (December 2023) — top 0.4% of NeurIPS submissions; only 2 main-track papers selected. For "Are Emergent Abilities of Large Language Models a Mirage?" (Schaeffer, Miranda, Koyejo).
- **EDGE Scholar**, Stanford University (September 2022) — Stanford fellowship supporting first-generation / low-income PhD scholars.
- **Stanford School of Engineering Fellowship** (September 2022) — multi-year departmental fellowship for incoming engineering PhDs.
- **Honorable Mention**, Ford Foundation Predoctoral Fellowship (2020, 2021) — national fellowship recognizing PhD applicants with potential to diversify the U.S. professoriate.
- **Best Research Project Award**, UIUC graduate course CS 598 "Learning to Learn" (December 2020).
- **Computer Science Excellence Saburo Muroga Endowed Fellow**, UIUC (2019-2020) — top departmental fellowship for incoming CS PhDs.
- **Most Cited Paper Certificate**, International Journal of Automation & Computing (IJAC, December 2019) — for "Why and when can deep- but not shallow-networks avoid the curse of dimensionality: a review".
- **Sloan Scholar**, Alfred P. Sloan Foundation Minority Ph.D. (MPHD) Program (2018-2019) — national fellowship for underrepresented STEM PhD students.
- **Grainger Engineering SURGE Fellowship**, UIUC (2018-2019) — multi-year college-level fellowship for diverse engineering PhDs.

Publications

Refereed Publications

(1) S. Barkallah, S. Daruru, Brando Miranda, Leni Aniva, Anima Nie, Sanmi Koyejo, *VeriBench-FTP: A Formal Theorem Proving Benchmark in Lean 4 for Code Verification.*
(**5th Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Workshop on Mathematical Reasoning and AI. 2025**)

(2) Brando Miranda, Zhangir Zhou, Anima Nie, Elio Obbad, Leni Aniva, Kai Fronsdal, William Kirk, Dogus Soylu, et al., *VeriBench: End-to-End Formal Verification Benchmark for AI Code Generation in Lean 4.*
(**2nd Workshop on AI for Math at International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML). 2025**; reviewer recommendation: **Accept (Oral, Top 1)**)

(3) Leni Aniva, Chuyue Sun, Brando Miranda, Clark Barrett, Sanmi Koyejo, *Pantograph: A machine-to-machine interaction interface for advanced theorem proving, high level reasoning, and data extraction in Lean 4.*
(**International Conference on Tools and Algorithms for the Construction and Analysis of Systems (TACAS). 2025**)

(4) Aryan Gulati, Brando Miranda, Eric Chen, Emily Xia, Kai Fronsdal, Bruno de Moraes Dumont, Sanmi Koyejo, *Putnam-AXIOM: A Functional & Static Benchmark for Measuring Higher Level Mathematical Reasoning in LLMs.*
(**International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML). 2025** & **Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Workshop on Mathematics and AI (MATH-AI). 2024**)

(5) Rylan Schaeffer, Hailey Schoelkopf, Brando Miranda, Gabriel Mukobi, Varun Madan, Adam Ibrahim, Herbie Bradley, Stella Biderman, Sanmi Koyejo, *Why Has Predicting Downstream Capabilities of Frontier AI Models with Scale Remained Elusive?.*
(**International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML). 2025** & **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) Workshop on Trustworthy Multi-modal Foundation Models and AI Agents (TiFA) — Outstanding Paper Award. 2024**)

(6) Zhangir Zhou, Xingrun Lu, Cheng Cao, Brando Miranda, Tong Liu, Bo Han, Sanmi Koyejo, *CoDaPO: Confidence and Difficulty-Adaptive Policy Optimization for Post-Training Language Models.*
(**2nd Workshop on AI for Math at International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML). 2025**)

(7) Rylan Schaeffer, Brando Miranda, Jiaqi Kazdan, Kaivu Liu, Amir M. Ahmed, Niloofar Mireshghallah, et al., *Causally Quantifying the Effect of Test Set Contamination on Generative Benchmarks.*
(**Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Workshop on Evaluating the Evolving LLM Lifecycle. 2025**)

(8) Rylan Schaeffer, Jiaqi Kazdan, Yarin Denisov-Blanch, Brando Miranda, Max Gerstgrasser, et al., *Position: Machine Learning Conferences Should Establish a 'Refutations and Critiques' Track.*
(**Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), Main Track. 2025**)

(9) Rylan Schaeffer, Dan Valentine, Luke Bailey, James Chua, et al., Brando Miranda, et al., Sanmi Koyejo, Ethan Perez, *Failures to Find Transferable Image Jailbreaks Between Vision-Language Models.*
(**International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR). 2024** & **Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Workshop on Red Teaming Generative AI. 2024**)

(10) Rylan Schaeffer, Mikail Khona, Sankarshan Chandra, Michael Ostrow, Brando Miranda, Sanmi Koyejo, *Does Maximizing Neural Regression Scores Teach Us About The Brain?.*
(**Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Workshop on Unifying Representations in Neural Models (UniReps), 2nd Edition. 2024**)

(11) Keshav Chawla, Aditya Sahai, Marco DePavia, Sathvik Sundar, Brando Miranda, *Quantifying the Importance of Data Alignment in Downstream Model Performance.*
(**International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) Workshop on Data-Centric Machine Learning Research (DMLR). 2024**)

(12) Aryan Gulati, Devanshu Ladsaria, Shubham Mishra, Jasdeep Sidhu, Brando Miranda, *An Evaluation Benchmark for Autoformalization in Lean4.*
(**International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) Tiny Papers Track, Second Edition. 2024**)

(13) Rylan Schaeffer, Brando Miranda, Sanmi Koyejo, *Are Emergent Abilities of Large Language Models a Mirage?.*
(**Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), Main Track. 2023 — Outstanding Paper Award & Oral**)

(14) Brando Miranda*, Alycia Lee*, Patrick Yu, Oluwasanmi Koyejo, *Beyond Scale: the Diversity Coefficient as a Data Quality Metric Demonstrates LLMs are Pre-trained on Formally Diverse Data.*
(**International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) Workshop on Data-Centric Machine Learning. 2023** & **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) Workshop on Deployable Generative AI. 2023**) (*equal contribution)

(15) Tomaso Poggio, Hrushikesh Mhaskar, Lorenzo Rosasco, Brando Miranda, Qianli Liao, *Why and when can deep-but not shallow-networks avoid the curse of dimensionality: a review.*
(**International Journal of Automation and Computing (IJAC). 2017 — Most Cited Paper Certificate**)

Preprints and Technical Reports

(1) D. Amrollahi, M. Karimi, Brando Miranda, Leni Aniva, Chuyue Sun, Clark Barrett, Sanmi Koyejo, *AI Coding Benchmarks Need Proofs, Not Just Tests.*
(**Preprint 2026**)

(2) W. Chan, M. Souliman, J. Nordhagen, Brando Miranda, Elyas Obbad, Sanmi Koyejo, *Lean-ing on Quality: How High-Quality Data Beats Diverse Multilingual Data in Autoformalization.*
(**Preprint 2025, arXiv:2502.15795**)

(3) Elyas Obbad, Iddah Mlauzi, Brando Miranda, Rylan Schaeffer, Kamal Obbad, Suhana Bedi, Sanmi Koyejo, *ZIP-FIT: Embedding-Free Data Selection via Compression-Based Alignment.*
(**Preprint 2024, arXiv:2410.18194**)

Professional Experience

Stanford University - Stanford, CA — *September 2022 - 2026 (expected)*
Ph.D. Student in Computer Science. Advisor: Professor Sanmi Koyejo

Amazon Web Services (AWS) - Cupertino, CA — *June 2024 - September 2024*
Applied Scientist Intern

Morph Labs - Remote — *October 2023 - December 2023*
Machine Learning Research Scientist Consultant

Wise Agents - Stanford Spin-out — *2023*
AI Research Consultant

IBM Research - Yorktown Heights, NY — *May 2022 - August 2022*
Graduate Research Intern

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign - Urbana-Champaign, IL — *September 2018 - May 2022*
Ph.D. Student in Computer Science. Advisor: Professor Sanmi Koyejo

IBM Research - Yorktown Heights, NY — *May 2021 - August 2021*
Graduate Research Intern

MIT CBMM (Center for Brain Minds & Machines) - Cambridge, MA — *June 2015 - September 2018*
Research Assistant. Advisor: Professor Tomaso Poggio

Media Coverage

- **Hacker News / Y Combinator (2025)**: Putnam-AXIOM benchmark posted on Hacker News — our *Putnam-AXIOM* benchmark for higher-level LLM mathematical reasoning drew front-page attention on Y Combinator's tech-news forum
- **White House Economic Report of the President (2024)**: Our work on emergent abilities was cited in the 2024 Economic Report of the President – the White House's annual flagship document on national economic policy
- **Quanta Magazine (2024)**: "How Quickly Do Large Language Models Learn Unexpected Skills?"
- **Andrew Ng (2024)**: Endorsed our paper as evidence that AGI development will be smooth and predictable
- **The New York Times (2023)**: "Silicon Valley Confronts the Idea That the 'Singularity' Is Here"

- **Forbes (2023)**: "AI 'Emergent Abilities' Are A Mirage, Says AI Researcher"
- **AK / @_akhaliq on X (2023)**: AK shared our *Beyond Scale* paper on X — the influential AI-research-paper aggregator (Gradio founder; now at HuggingFace) tweeted our *Beyond Scale* paper to his large research audience (68.9K views)
- **Stanford AI Lab Blog (ICML 2023)**: Our *Beyond Scale* and *Is Pre-training Truly Better Than Meta-Learning?* papers were featured in the Stanford AI Lab blog roundup of ICML 2023
- **Additional coverage**: Stanford HAI, Y Combinator News, Vice, Medium, HackerNews, NeurIPS blog, Reddit

Invited & Contributed Talks

- **Applications of Trustworthy Machine Reasoning with AI Coding Agents** – AAAI 2026 Tutorial "Trustworthy Machine Reasoning with Foundation Models" (Part IV, 50 min), Singapore, January 2026
- **Emergent Abilities in Large Language Models: Mirage or an Elusive Predictive Frontier?** – Hong Kong Baptist University, Department of Computer Science Seminar, Hong Kong, January 2026
- **Failures to Find Transferable Image Jailbreaks Between Vision-Language Models** – NeurIPS Red Teaming GenAI Workshop, Contributed Talk, December 2024
- **Are Emergent Abilities of Large Language Models a Mirage?** – Stanford IEEE Invited Talk, Stanford, CA, 2023
- **The Curse of Low Task Diversity: On the Failure of Transfer Learning to Outperform MAML** – NeurIPS Meta-Learning Workshop, Contributed Talk, New Orleans, LA, December 2022

Teaching Experience

Stanford University *2023 - 2025*
Course Assistant (3 quarters) & Instructor of Record (Spring)

- CS 197 *How to Do CS Research* with Prof. Michael Bernstein — TA'd 3 quarters; **Instructor of Record** for the Spring offering
- Mentored undergraduate research that produced **2 workshop publications** (including ICML workshop tracks)

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *August 2020 - December 2020*
Graduate Teaching Assistant

- CS 446 Machine Learning
- Designed problem sets and exams; held weekly office hours

Massachusetts Institute of Technology *2014-2016*
Graduate Teaching Assistant

- Statistical Learning Theory & Applications (9.520/6.860) with Prof. Lorenzo Rosasco & Tomaso Poggio
- Introduction to Algorithms (6.006) with Prof. Nancy Lynch, Bruce Tidor and Aleksander Madry
- Design & Analysis of Algorithms (6.046) with Prof. Shafi Goldwasser, Dana Moshkovitz, Nir Shavit
- Introduction to Machine Learning (6.036) with Prof. Tommi Jaakkola, Suvrit Sra & Regina Barzilay

Leadership & Service

Research Mentorship *2016 - Present*

- Mentored undergraduate and graduate students at Stanford, UIUC, and MIT CBMM
- Led research teams on data quality metrics, meta-learning, and formal reasoning

Academic Service *2018 - Present*

- Founding member of Stanford AI for Lean, a research community advancing AI for Lean theorem proving and formalizing mathematics
- Reviewer for NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2026, ICML 2026 (**Silver Reviewer** – top reviewer recognition), ICLR 2025, ICML 2025 AI4MATH Workshop, ICLR 2024 DMLR Workshop, NeurIPS 2023 MATH-AI Workshop, ICLR 2020, JMLR 2018
- Graduate advisor for Latinos in Computer Science (LCS) at UIUC
- Founded "Stanford Bachata Sensual & Brazilian Zouk" and "UIUC Bachata Sensual & Zouk" official student organizations

Outreach *2017 - Present*

- Distributed Research Experiences for Undergraduates (DREU) UIUC 2019
- Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program (UROP) MIT 2017-2018
- Engineering of Intelligence Team (EIT) CBMM MIT 2017-2018

Skills & Tools

Programming: Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, JAX, Lean 4, OCaml, Coq
ML/AI Tools: Hugging Face, Weights & Biases, DSPy, git, UNIX
Languages: English, Spanish (native fluency)